

Leading the Pack

In this edition of *BT's Most Powerful Women in Business*, we look at power, but through the lens of profit. This is how we did it.

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WHAT DEFINES A powerful woman? Is it perception? Is it regular appearances in media? Or is it defined by her position as a businesswoman, corporate professional, or influential policymaker? Can there be an objective metric to identify India's most powerful women in business? At *Business Today*, we grappled with these questions before we decided we could rely on data to identify women who truly wield power in business. *Et voilà!* That's how we compiled the Most Powerful Women in Business 2025 list.

This is not the first time we have pivoted towards data in recent times. A couple of months ago, we used the profitability metric to identify top-performing listed companies in the *BT500* issue. We are using the same profitability metric to identify the most powerful women in the listed universe of companies. After all, profit is power!

So how did we do it? For the Most Powerful Women in Business 2025 list, BT Research undertook an extensive exercise to identify women, including chairpersons, vice chairpersons, managing directors, joint managing directors, chief executive officers, whole-time directors/ executive directors (promoters) leading India's most profitable companies. From the universe of listed firms, we shortlisted the top 100 profitable companies which are led by women, ensuring the focus remained on financially strong and operationally significant businesses. We ranked the leaders as per the consolidated PAT of the company (**See tables on pages 172-179**).

The list and the whole issue reflect both the scale of business performance and the growing leadership footprint of women in corporate India. It is not a ranking but a recognition of women whose companies' financial success underscores their strategic and leadership capabilities. **BT**

—BY TEAM **BT**